

Lean

Thinking focused on maximizing value, improving flow, reducing waste and continuously learning.

What is Lean?

Lean seeks to maximize value and reduce waste in the work system. It does not simply mean “go faster” or “cut people”; it means understanding what creates value and continuously improving flow.

Waste in software

Waiting for environments, queues, excessive handoffs, rework, late defects, partially completed work and repetitive manual activities can consume effort without proportional value.

Flow example

A feature waits four days for an environment, QA finds a bug, it returns to development, a new build waits two more days and is retested. Total elapsed time includes substantial waiting and rework.

Lean applied to quality

QA can help prevent defects earlier, reduce rework, improve data and environments, automate repetitive feedback and expose queues and risks. The goal is not more tests; it is improving the system's ability to deliver quality.

Continuous improvement

Observe current work, identify meaningful waste, try a small improvement, measure the result and learn. Lean favors evolutionary, evidence-based improvement.

Lean, Kanban and Scrum

Lean provides principles around value, flow and waste. Kanban manages and improves flow with practices such as visualization and WIP. Scrum is a framework with accountabilities, events, artifacts and commitments. They are related but not synonyms.

Watch out

Removing a step only because it takes time can increase risk. Before removing documentation, tests or reviews, understand what value and protection the activity provides and whether a better way exists.